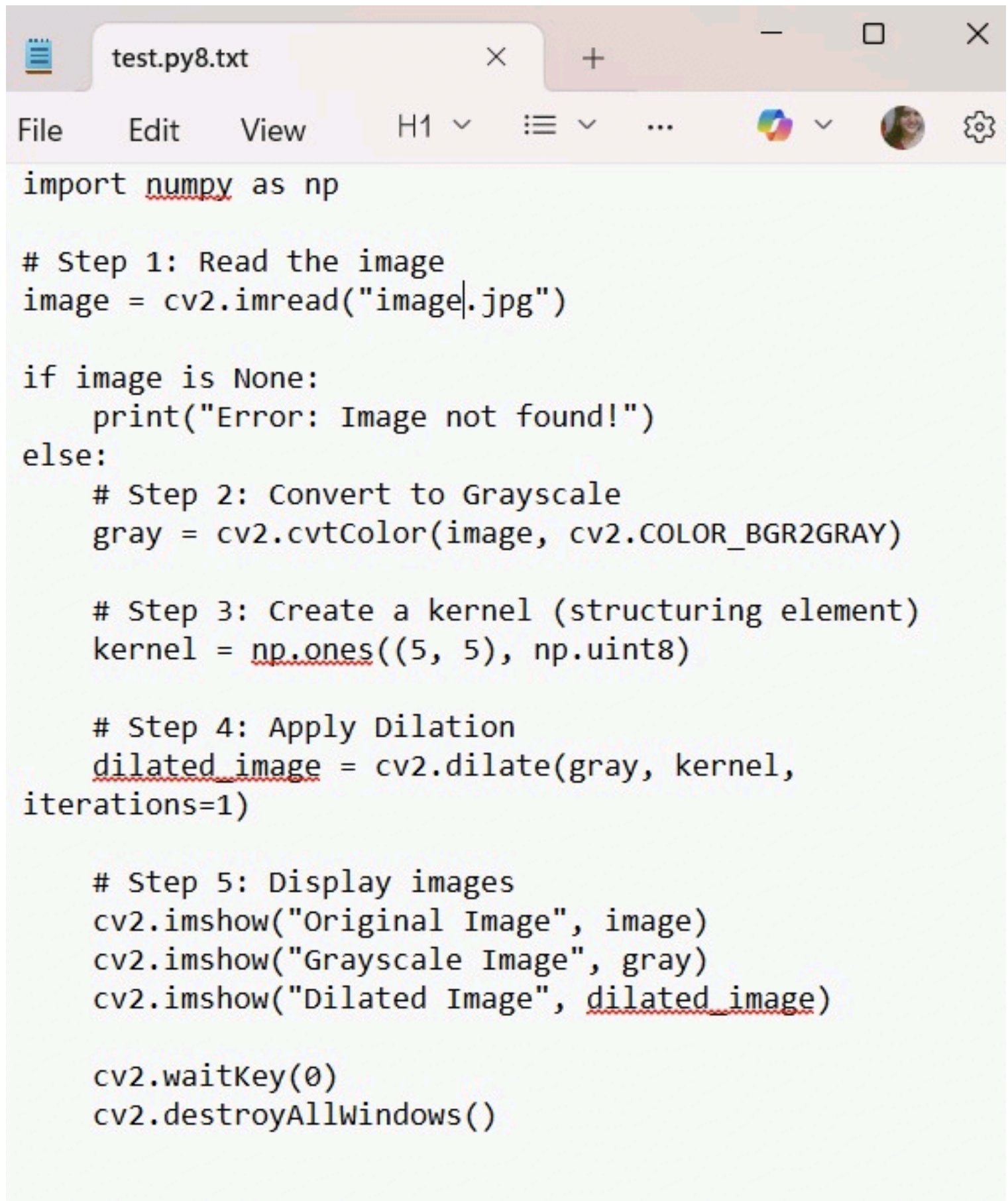






```
import numpy as np

# Step 1: Read the image
image = cv2.imread("image.jpg")

if image is None:
    print("Error: Image not found!")
else:
    # Step 2: Convert to Grayscale
    gray = cv2.cvtColor(image, cv2.COLOR_BGR2GRAY)

    # Step 3: Create a kernel (structuring element)
    kernel = np.ones((5, 5), np.uint8)

    # Step 4: Apply Dilation
    dilated_image = cv2.dilate(gray, kernel,
iterations=1)

    # Step 5: Display images
    cv2.imshow("Original Image", image)
    cv2.imshow("Grayscale Image", gray)
    cv2.imshow("Dilated Image", dilated_image)

    cv2.waitKey(0)
    cv2.destroyAllWindows()
```